



INTERNATIONAL DYSLEXIA ASSOCIATION INSTITUTIONAL ACCREDITATION PLAN

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1 INTRODUCTION

1.1 INTENT OF IDA ACCREDITATION

The intent of [Institutional Accreditation](#) is to assist institutions worldwide to develop services that are both high-quality, sustainable, and reasonable for different cultural contexts. Institutional Accreditation is a *developmental process* with guidance and mentoring from IDA experts.

1.2 PURPOSE OF INSTITUTIONAL QUALITY STANDARDS

The purpose of [Institutional Quality Standards](#) is to establish uniform criteria for institutions seeking Institutional Accreditation by the International [Dyslexia](#) Association (IDA). The goals of these standards are to:

- Improve and validate the quality of information and services available to people with dyslexia, including educators, parents, students and other stakeholders
- Provide an organizational framework to mentor applicant institutions which provide services related to dyslexia and other learning disabilities.
- Assist IDA affiliates in maintaining consistently high quality operational standards
- Increase transparency of external quality assurance

1.3 INSTITUTIONAL ACCREDITATION

IDA Institutional Accreditation is a formal recognition that the institution meets professional standards of operational integrity and quality related to services reasonable within local cultural contexts and consistent with IDA's values and definition of dyslexia.

2 INSTITUTIONAL QUALITY STANDARDS & [KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS](#)

2.1 INSTITUTIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

The institution must have a non-provisional, government-issued [license to operate](#).

Key Performance Indicators

- Non-provisional, government-issued license to operate

2.2 [MISSION](#) AND PLANNING

The institution has a current [Strategic Plan](#) that covers a minimum of three (3) years. This Strategic Plan must have (a) clearly defined [vision](#), [mission](#), [goals](#) and [objectives](#) and (b) Key Performance Indicators to measure the progress of the institution.

The institution is dedicated to meeting the challenges of dyslexia and how to empower individuals with dyslexia in various contexts.

Key Performance Indicators

- Current strategic plan that covers a minimum of three years.
- [Vision statement](#)
- [Mission statement](#)
- Institutional [Goals](#) and [Objectives](#) that reflect the Mission
- Tools used to measure progress or assess program effectiveness and/or [client](#) satisfaction
- Description of Key Performance Indicators that measure the institution's progress towards meeting the goals and objectives.
- Evidence of shared values and understanding of dyslexia between the Institution and IDA
- Evidence that institutional mission and goals are clearly reflected in publications

2.3 ORGANIZATIONAL AND FINANCIAL RESOURCES

The institution has clearly-written policies and procedures for all mission-critical aspects of operation.

The institution has documented sources of financial support to sustain efficient operations.

The institution has standard accounting and reporting processes that are nationally acceptable.

Key Performance Indicators

- Audited accounting statement for the past fiscal year
- Documentation of the financial resources, sources of funding, and current operating reserve
- Documentation showing that the current resources are sustainable
- Written Policies and procedures

2.4 PERSONNEL QUALIFICATIONS

The administration shows a clearly-defined structure and function with well- defined roles and responsibilities.

The administrative personnel have qualifications appropriate for the institution's organizational management.

All non-native English speakers who teach English will provide documentation of English proficiency.

Key Performance Indicators

- [Organizational chart](#)
- Numbers and roles of employees, categorized by full- or part-time status and category (e.g., [executive](#), [administrative](#), [professional](#), [support staff](#))
- Copies of credentials and/or letters confirming employee qualifications
- Ratio of clients to [providers](#)
- Clearly-written job descriptions that include required qualifications
- Written policies and procedures for evaluating employees
- Evaluation tools or forms used for evaluating all employees
- For non-native English speakers who teach English:
 - TOEFL Overall score of 600 (paper-based) or 93 (internet-based) with a Test of Written English score of at least: Listening 22, Reading 22, Speaking 25, and Writing 24. Any equivalent national test (e.g., the Singapore-Cambridge General Certificate of Education Ordinary Level exam) as per the country norms will be accepted

2.5 [FACILITIES](#) AND INFRASTRUCTURES

The physical site, technology, equipment and materials are safe, well- maintained and appropriate for the institution's stated mission, goals and objectives.

Key Performance Indicators

- Documentation showing that the institution's physical site, equipment and materials are appropriate and adequate for the goals and objectives (e.g., facility photographs, site floor plan, list and/or descriptions of specialized equipment or materials)
- Documentation and the site-visit show that the building and grounds provide safe environments that are reasonable within local conventions
- Documentation of safety by appropriate safety experts, including fire-safety and earthquake (if appropriate)
- Documentation showing that the instructional and/or informational materials are up-to-date and aligned with the IDA shared values and understanding of dyslexia
- Documentation showing maintenance and replacement schedule for the facility, technology and any specialized equipment.

2.6 [COMMUNICATION](#) AND [ENGAGEMENT](#)

Internal:

- The institution maintains consistent and transparent communication regarding the vision, mission, goals and objectives among all internal departments and employees.

External:

- The institution maintains consistent and transparent communications among affiliates, including branches, clients and stakeholders.
- The institution maintains consistent and transparent communication with external institutions with similar missions at the local, regional, national and international levels.

Key Performance Indicators

- Internally, documentation that shows how the institution maintains consistent and transparent communication regarding vision, mission, goals and objectives among all internal departments and employees
- Externally, documentation that shows how this institution maintains consistent and transparent communication among affiliates, including branches (if any), clients, other stakeholders, and other institutions with similar missions at the local, regional, national and international levels

2.7 [IMPACT](#) AND RELATIONSHIPS

The institution cultivates and maintains strategic alliances with individuals and organizations with the [resources](#) to advance the institution's mission.

Key Performance Indicators

- Written strategy for forming and maintaining alliances with individuals and organizations with the resources to advance the institution's mission
- Evidence of strategic alliances
- Evidence of any joint or affiliated program offerings with any third-party institution(s)

2.8 SELF-EVALUATION AND ONGOING DEVELOPMENT

The institution has documented procedures for regular and continuous self-evaluation and ongoing development for all aspects of operation.

Key Performance Indicators

- Institutional plan for regular and continuous self-evaluation and ongoing development of mission and goals
- [Outcome](#) data that shows the benefits or changes to your target audience
- [Output](#) data that shows the measures of the institution's programs and activities
- Description of how the institution evaluates the quality of its programs and services.
- List of improvements to programs, services and/or facilities the institution plans to undertake in the next 12 months.
- Reports of internal and external reviews of the institution.
- Minutes of committee meetings.

3 INSTITUTION ELIGIBILITY AND LEVELS

3.1 ELIGIBILITY FOR IDA ACCREDITATION

The institution must be a current Global Partner of IDA in good standing.

IDA offers Institutional Accreditation to non-governmental organizations (NGOs), non-profit, not-for-profit institutions whose purpose is to support wholly or partially the well-being of individuals with dyslexia and related conditions and to maximize these individuals' contributions to their communities.

The institution must have an established legal basis or a permanent, non-provisional, government-issued [license to operate](#).

The institution must comply with any legal requirements of the legislative jurisdiction within which it operates and must provide evidence and written documentation for this status.

3.2 MULTIPLE SITES

Institutions that offer identical services at multiple sites, each of which has its own administration and facilities, is entitled to accreditation if these conditions are met:

- (a) Documentation shows that the services offered are identical to the primary institution.
- (b) Personnel have appropriate [qualifications](#) for each position.
- (c) On-site accreditation visits must be scheduled to document the presence of Institutional Quality Standards.

3.3 TERM OF ACCREDITATION

Accreditation period is valid for a period of four (4) years.

To maintain accreditation, an institution must apply for re-accreditation twelve (12) months prior to the expiration of its current accreditation status.

3.4 LEVELS OF ACCREDITATION

Level I (Applicant for Accreditation)

- This status is given to institutions whose application for Institutional Accreditation has been accepted but are still working towards the recommendation of the accreditation visit team.

Level II (Provisional Accreditation)

This status is awarded to institutions which (1) have a mission that is congruent with that of IDA's (2) have a non-provisional, government-issued license to operate, (3) have a current three year strategic plan, and (4) have met at least 50% of the criteria for three of the six remaining Institutional Quality Standards. Institutions awarded this status need to improve their operational processes to achieve a higher status, or they have successfully completed the majority of the criteria, pending a site visit from the Peer-Review team.

Level III (Full Accreditation)

- This status is awarded to institutions which meet the criteria for all IDA Institutional Quality Standards.

Level IV (Full Accreditation with Commendation)

- This status is awarded to well-established institutions which have consistently met the criteria for all IDA Institutional Quality Standards for three (3) review cycles.

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4 INSTITUTIONAL INSTITUTION PROCESS

4.1 EVALUATION REQUEST

The Institution formally initiates an accreditation review by submitting an Initial Accreditation Application.

4.2 IDA SUPPORT AND MENTORING FOR APPLICATION PROCESS

The IDA Home Office provides support and mentoring for the Institution's application.

4.3 IDA SUPPORT AND MENTORING FOR ACCREDITATION PROCESS

An assigned IDA Mentor provides support and mentoring for Institution to guide you through the accreditation process and help you identify and assemble the accreditation criteria and documents outlined in the Self-Study Report.

4.4 SELF-STUDY REPORT

The Institution conducts a self-study to assess their strengths and areas for improvement based on the IDA Institutional Quality Standards.

The institution must include requested documentation required in section 2.5 - Facilities and Infrastructure.

The Institution prepares and submits a Self-Study Report.

4.5 EXTERNAL REVIEW – PROVISIONAL ACCREDITATION

IDA-appointed peer-reviewers from outside the institution analyze the self-study report and review the on-site documentation provided by applicant.

4.6 PEER-REVIEW TEAM REPORT – PROVISIONAL ACCREDITATION

The IDA Peer-Review Team presents their findings to the IDA Accreditation Committee for approval of provisional Accreditation status.

4.7 REVIEW AND DECISION – PROVISIONAL ACCREDITATION

The IDA Accreditation Committee makes the decision to award provisional Accreditation based on the findings of the Peer-Review Team.

4.8 EXTERNAL REVIEW – PROVISIONAL ACCREDITATION

IDA-appointed peer-reviewers from outside the institution conducts an on-site evaluation to analyze the self-study report and review on-site documentation provided by applicant.

4.9 PEER-REVIEW TEAM REPORT – FULL ACCREDITATION

The IDA Peer-Review Team presents their findings to the IDA Accreditation Committee for approval of full Accreditation status.

4.10 REVIEW AND DECISION – FULL ACCREDITATION

The IDA Accreditation Committee makes the decision to award full Accreditation based on the findings of the Peer-Review Team.

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APPENDIX A: REFERENCES

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APPENDIX B: KEY TERMS

Term	Definition
<i>Administrative Employee</i>	An employee who performs office work directly related to the management or general business operations of the institution
<i>Client</i>	A person using the services of the institution
<i>Communication</i>	Exchanging information.
<i>Dyslexia</i>	Dyslexia is a specific learning disability that is neurobiological in origin. It is characterized by difficulties with accurate and/or fluent word recognition and by poor spelling and decoding abilities. These difficulties typically result from a deficit in the phonological component of language that is often unexpected in relation to other cognitive abilities and the provision of effective classroom instruction. Secondary consequences may include problems in reading comprehension and reduced reading experience that can impede growth of vocabulary and background knowledge. (IDA, 2002)
<i>Engagement</i>	The process of getting and keeping attention.
<i>Executive Employee</i>	An employee who manages an institution or department within the institution
<i>Facilities</i>	A building or equipment made for a specific purpose.
<i>Goal</i>	A goal is an overarching statement focusing on one area that is explicitly linked to the institution's mission. Goal statements identify the specific population and focus.
<i>IDA</i>	International Dyslexia Association
<i>Impact</i>	To have a strong effect on someone.
<i>Institutional Accreditation</i>	The formal recognition by the International Dyslexia Association (IDA) that an institution that provides services related to dyslexia and other learning disabilities meets professional standards of operational integrity and quality as outlined in the IDA Institutional Quality Standards.
<i>Institutional Quality Standards</i>	Guidelines for quality assurance

<i>Key Performance Indicator</i>	A measurable value that demonstrates how effectively an institution is achieving stated objectives; they are used to evaluate success.
<i>License to Operate</i>	<i>A legal document that grants the right to operate a business</i>
<i>Mission Statement</i>	A succinct, present-based statement describing why the institution exists. It includes what the institution aspires to do, for whom, and how it functions.
<i>Objective</i>	Objectives are specific, measurable steps taken to meet that goal with a specified time frame.
<i>Organizational Chart</i>	A diagram showing how an organization is structured. It shows the roles, responsibilities and relationships between individuals within an organization.
<i>Outcome</i>	The benefit or change to clients as a result of the objectives and outputs; client satisfaction, achievements, tangible indicators of improved performance, including attitude, skill, knowledge, behavior or status.
<i>Output</i>	Numerical measures of the volume of an institution's activities (e.g., numbers of people served, number of workshops held, number of informational brochures distributed.)
<i>Professional Employee</i>	An employee with a specialized academic degree who performs predominantly intellectual work requiring advanced knowledge
<i>Provider</i>	A person who provides services to clients.
<i>Qualifications</i>	A specialized skill, experience or knowledge that makes someone suitable to do a particular job or activity
<i>Resources</i>	A supply of money, materials, staff, or other assets that can be used by a person or institution in order to function effectively.
<i>Strategic Plan</i>	An institution's identified long-term goals and the best approach for achieving those goals.
<i>Support Staff</i>	Employees who support the facilities or people involved in the institution's main business
<i>Vision Statement</i>	A succinct, future-based statement that states what the institution wants to be or do. It is meant to inspire and guide employees.

